

Users

Individuals starting their professional journeys in IT-related fields who possess the necessary technical knowledge but need to develop essential soft skills to excel in their roles.

Problem

Recent IT graduates don't usually have the soft-skills employers are looking for in new hires, stunting their job opportunities and professional growth.

¿What do we want to build?

A Soft-skill training platform that provides the user with effective activities based on the available soft skill research and has a hands-on approach to learning unlike the existing alternatives.

User research planning (idealized)

1- Demographic and Biographical Questions

What is the age range of the users?

What is their current level of education?

What stage of their professional life are they in (students, recent graduates, job seekers)?

What is their economic situation (income, financial dependence)?

Where do they live (urban, suburban, rural)?

What kind of technological access do they have (devices, connectivity)?

2- Questions about Work Context

What type of companies or roles do they expect to work in?

What are the most common challenges they face when entering the workforce?

What type of work culture do they expect to find?

3- Questions about Soft Skills

a) Necessary for professional performance:

What are the most important soft skills for success in the IT field?

What skills are key for working in multidisciplinary teams?

b) Most lacking:

What soft skills are often lacking in IT students when starting their professional lives?

What difficulties do they face when interacting in professional environments?

c) Demanded by employers:

What soft skills do employers look for in junior IT candidates?

What skills are most valued in remote or hybrid work environments?

Motivational Questions

How would you describe the typical personality of these users?

What beliefs or attitudes do they have about soft skills?

What motivates them to improve their social skills?

What fears or insecurities do they have when facing the professional world?

Questions about Barriers and Pain Points

What obstacles have they faced in developing soft skills?

What prevents them from communicating effectively at work?

Questions about Learning Preferences

What learning format do they prefer?

What type of content do they find most engaging?

How will we get this information?

Scientific research: There is a lot of available information about softskills and their importance in IT related fields, using the sources compiled on the bibliography document we can gather a lot of useful information.

Surveys: Using the survey available on this url: <https://forms.office.com/r/Mj86jxtbCp> we can get information that is more specific to our users and cannot be compiled from existing sources

Interviews: Ideally, we could perform a couple of interviews to people who fit the description for our primary user, this way we can get some more personal information and contrast if their thoughts on the topic are similar.

Similar apps

There are similar apps available to train soft skills, even though each one uses a different way to teach the users. Here are some examples:

1. Coursera

This app is very popular among students who want to learn something new or improve their knowledge in a specific area. This app also offers a very good amount of softskills courses that cater to various career goals and learning styles.

Most popular Coursera's courses:

- People and Soft Skills for Professional and Personal Success

Skills Covered: Leadership, Management, Communication, Problem Solving, Collaboration, Conflict Management, Presentations, Agile Methodology, Public Speaking, and more.

Description: This specialization includes five short courses followed by a final assessment. It focuses on developing essential people and soft skills for professional success, with real-life scenarios and case studies.

- Career Success Specialization

Skills Covered: Project Management, Time Management, Finance, Communication, Negotiation, Leadership, Problem-Solving, and Entrepreneurship.

Description: It provides a robust skillset for career advancement, focusing on real-world challenges and practical applications.

According to Coursera, these courses are designed to be accessible to learners of all levels, with flexible durations and a focus on practical application.

2. Platzi

Platzi is a platform in with many courses (especially about software development) for the ones who want to avoid the traditional way to obtain knowledge. According to Platzi it's courses s emphasize practical application and real-world scenarios, making it a valuable resource for those looking to enhance their professional abilities. The language of this platform is spanish and some of them give certificates.

Examples:

- **Curso de Habilidades Blandas para el Desarrollo Profesional**

This course helps identify and develop essential soft skills for professional success. It covers topics like self-awareness, productivity, physical and mental health, assertive communication, public speaking, continuous learning, and leadership.

- **Escuela de liderazgo y Management**

This school focuses on developing leadership and management skills, including time management and productivity.

In both platforms you must pay for some courses and the free ones do not give benefits like a certification. Another very important thing to point out is that their courses are mostly theory and it is hard to practice the things you learn just with what they offer.